

Afton Gauntlett, Frontend Engineer

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Portfolio (<https://aftongauntlett.com>) | LinkedIn (<https://linkedin.com/in/afton-gauntlett/>) | GitHub (<https://github.com/aftongauntlett>)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Frontend engineer with six years of professional experience in design systems, accessible UI, and component architecture. Led an Angular-to-React migration, built a multi-theme Storybook design system, and shipped production tooling at Booz Allen Hamilton — earning three internal awards and a spot representing the team at AWS re:Invent.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

TypeScript • JavaScript • React • Next.js • Astro • Vue • Tailwind CSS • Framer Motion • GSAP • Storybook • TanStack Query • Playwright • Jest • Figma • Design Systems • WCAG • Section 508 • Supabase • PostgreSQL • Vercel • Git • GitHub Copilot • Claude

EXPERIENCE

Booz Allen Hamilton

Lead Engineer

03/2023 - 05/2025

- Built and maintained a Storybook component library and multi-theme design system adopted across multiple production React applications, reducing redundant UI work and establishing shared patterns the whole team shipped from.
- Designed and delivered a stepper-driven data portal in close collaboration with stakeholders — using interactive prototypes to win buy-in over a competing proposal on a high-value contract.
- Identified and scoped an opportunity for a secure LLM-powered chatbot, coordinated with MLOps to stand up the low-side environment, and owned the frontend interface and UX polish from prototype through production.

Software Engineer

03/2022 - 03/2023

- Led an Angular-to-React migration focused on UI structure, component reuse, and long-term maintainability — establishing the design system and design workflows the team still uses.
- Owned Section 508 compliance across production applications, authoring shared accessibility standards and patterns that made interfaces usable by default.
- Introduced Prettier, ESLint, Husky, and TanStack Query — modernizing the frontend toolchain and shifting the team from class-based to functional components.
- Supported QA team with smoke test authoring and test documentation; trained testers on Postman for API validation ahead of UI availability.
- Authored onboarding documentation and accessibility guides that reduced ramp-up time and made new developers productive faster.

Gauntlet Designs, Founder

01/2020 - Present (Freelance)

- Founded a full-stack web studio delivering accessible, production-ready sites for small businesses and nonprofits, leading projects from scope through deployment.
- Designed and built a multi-state employee portal and scheduling platform for a major restaurant franchise, still in active use after five years.
- Established reusable component patterns and documentation across all client projects, reducing inconsistency and improving handoff.

IronClad, UI Developer

01/2022 - 03/2022

- Delivered wireframes and interaction specs that defined the React component architecture for Defense Intelligence Agency web applications.
- Authored accessibility and UI standards adopted as the shared reference for design and engineering alignment.

Global Dimensions, Web Developer

08/2021 - 01/2022

- Built a scroll-driven animated timeline for NGA analyst platforms using Vue, GSAP, and CSS — set as the visual reference standard for the project.
- Translated motion-heavy design specs into accessible, performant components without sacrificing fidelity or performance, including hands-on JAWS screen reader testing during accessibility validation.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Platinum Award (Booz Allen Hamilton)

2024

Built a convention registration and scheduling platform used by 100+ attendees for session sign-ups and on-site coordination.

Gold Award (Booz Allen Hamilton)

2023

Prototyped competing design directions for stakeholder review — the selected direction directly influenced a multi-year contract award.

Gold Award (Booz Allen Hamilton)

2022

Redesigned a high-visibility internal application; improved usability earned recognition from Amazon developers at AWS re:Invent.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

George Washington University, 2020

Web Development Certification

General Assembly, 2022

User Experience Design

CompTIA, 2022

Security+ (Active)

PROJECTS & VOLUNTEER WORK

no-wb.org

no-wb.org

Job search dashboard built on the Hiring Without Whiteboards dataset. Watches the upstream repo for merged PRs via GitHub Actions, pulls the latest data on merge, and writes to static JSON — no database, no server. Full-text search, filtering, pagination. Astro, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS.

Orbital Order (JS13k)

github.com/aftongauntlett/js13k-demo

Physics-based puzzle game built under a 13KB size constraint. Vanilla JavaScript, Canvas 2D, Web Audio API. Emergent charge mechanics inspired by the Aufbau principle. No frameworks, no libraries.

Pretty Pretty Pretty Good

prettyprettyprettygood.org/

Sliding-scale web studio for nonprofits. I take clients from zero to a live production site solo — scope, architecture, design, build, deployment. Astro, Vercel, Upstash Redis.